

HEM NIKESH GABHAWALA

Cybersecurity Engineer — VAPT → Governance, Risk & Compliance

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SUMMARY

B.Tech Computer Science (Cybersecurity) student with hands-on experience in vulnerability assessment, penetration testing, and network analysis, now moving toward Governance, Risk & Compliance and AI Security. Completed a live VAPT internship at HackersVilla Cybersecurity, reached the top 2% on TryHackMe across 175+ labs, and built a self-hosted GRC platform from the ground up. Brings an attacker's understanding of vulnerabilities into governance and risk work, rather than starting from compliance checklists alone. Also building applied machine learning fundamentals and using AI-assisted development tooling (Claude Code) to build and ship faster.

KEY EXPERTISE

Primary:

Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT) · Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) · AI Security

Secondary:

Ethical Hacking · Network Security · Web Application Security · Risk Management · Cryptography · Linux/Unix Administration · Python Programming

EXPERIENCE

HackersVilla Cybersecurity Pvt. Ltd. — Cybersecurity Intern

Mar – May 2024

- Performed live vulnerability assessments, penetration testing, and network reconnaissance under senior engineer supervision.
 - Assisted with vulnerability analysis, technical documentation, and remediation reporting.
 - Learned risk management techniques and security best practices; worked with Linux and scripting in a professional security workflow.
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PROJECTS

Dharma — Self-Hosted GRC Platform

- Built a self-hosted governance, risk, and compliance platform that maps audit evidence to controls using a local AI model — sensitive documents never leave the organization.
- Built automated compliance evidence collection and hash-

chained, tamper-evident audit trails.

- Built with Python and Docker for scalable, self-hosted deployment.

VaultIQ — Zero-Knowledge AI Platform

- Built a secure AI-powered document platform with client-side AES-256 encryption, so files are encrypted before they're ever uploaded.
- Trained a machine-learning ensemble that flags AI-generated submissions.
- Built REST APIs with FastAPI; containerized with Docker.

Enterprise API Security & Penetration Testing

- Performed API penetration testing and identified vulnerabilities against the OWASP API Top 10.
 - Documented findings with actionable remediation recommendations.
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CERTIFICATIONS

Advanced Security:

- **Offensive Pentesting** — TryHackMe (2025): Advanced penetration testing, privilege escalation, Active Directory security.
- **Web Application Pentesting** — TryHackMe (2025): Web and API vulnerabilities via the OWASP Top 10.

Foundational Security:

- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate** — Coursera (2024): Network security, risk management, incident response, Python, SQL.
- **Jr Penetration Tester** — TryHackMe (2025): Vulnerability assessment and penetration testing in lab environments.

- **Web Fundamentals** — TryHackMe (2025): Web technologies and web security fundamentals.
- **Cyber Security 101** — TryHackMe (2025): Cryptography, networking, defensive security concepts.
- **Pre Security** — TryHackMe (2024): Networking, Linux, Windows, and cybersecurity foundations.

Specialized:

- **ISEA Digital Certificate** — CDAC / MeitY (2024)
 - **AWS Academy — Data Engineering** (2026): AWS data pipelines, storage, cloud analytics.
 - **AWS Academy — Machine Learning Foundations** (2026): ML fundamentals and AWS AI services.
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TOOLS & PLATFORMS

Burp Suite · Nmap · Metasploit · Wireshark · Git & GitHub · Docker · AWS · VS Code · Postman

EDUCATION

Navrachana University — B.Tech, Computer Science (Cybersecurity)
2023–2027

CGPA: 7.81 (through Semester 6)

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Top 2% globally on TryHackMe; 175+ hands-on cybersecurity labs completed.

- Built and shipped a self-hosted GRC platform and an AI security platform, end to end.
 - 10 industry certifications across cybersecurity, cloud, and AI.
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LANGUAGES

English, Hindi, Gujarati